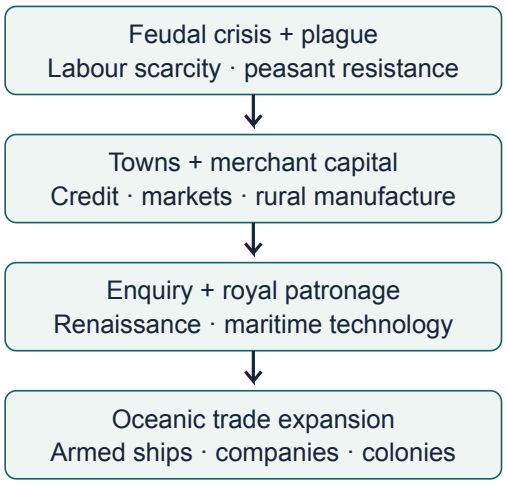
Rise of British Supremacy: A Backgrounder

1. European background: feudalism to commercial expansion

- **Feudalism:** land-based hierarchy linking kings, lords/vassals and dependent peasants/serfs; Church authority influential. Military service, rents and customary obligations sustained the system.
- **Fourteenth-century crisis:** agricultural constraints, warfare and **Black Death (Europe, 1347–51; England, 1348)** reduced population and left land uncultivated. Attempts to retain labour/services provoked peasant resistance.
- **Western Europe:** serfdom gradually weakened; towns, wage labour and commercial agriculture expanded. **Eastern Europe:** landlords later strengthened serfdom—Europe followed different paths.
- **Italian commercial towns:** Venice, Genoa, Milan and Florence; Mediterranean/Asian commerce and merchant wealth supported urban growth. **Marco Polo (1254–1324)** associated with travel to China. Italian city-states were not a unified Italian nation-State.
- **Renaissance, fourteenth–sixteenth centuries:** revival of classical learning; art, architecture, literature, science and enquiry; began in Italy. **Reformation, sixteenth century:** challenges to Catholic authority and emergence of Protestant churches; religious and political change.
- **Commercial revolution:** expanding markets, currency, banking/credit, communications and towns such as London, Paris and Amsterdam. Rural manufacture/proto-industry preceded mechanised factories.



European change helped create the conditions for overseas commercial expansion.

2. Voyages: motives, routes and turning points

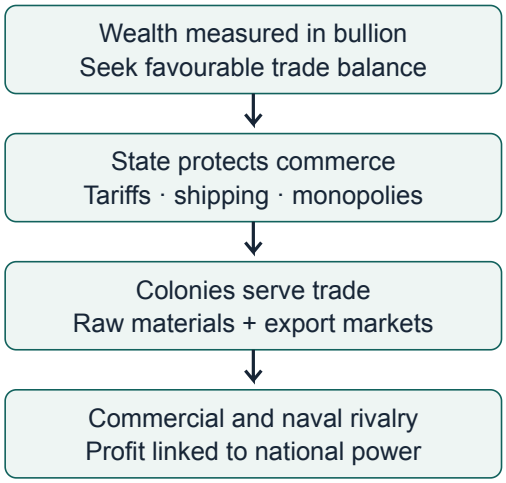
- Motives: profitable **pepper/spice trade**, direct access to Asian goods, bypassing Arab/Italian intermediaries, royal competition and Christian missions—**"God, Glory, Gold"**.
- **Ottoman capture of Constantinople, 1453**, increased concern over established routes; it did not instantly close all Europe–Asia trade. Ottoman control of Egypt/Red Sea belongs to a later phase.
- Navigation, maps, compass, improved ships and gunpowder, backed by centralising monarchies, enabled armed oceanic ventures. **Prince Henry the Navigator:** Portuguese patron of exploration.

- **Bartolomeu Dias, 1488:** rounded southern Africa; Cape of Storms became **Cape of Good Hope**. His expedition began in 1487.
- **Christopher Columbus, 1492:** Italian navigator sailing for Spain reached the Americas, already inhabited; he did not reach India.
- **Vasco da Gama, 1498:** reached **Calicut/Kozhikode**, ruled by **Zamorin**, via the Cape, under Portugal's **Manuel I**. Established the direct Portuguese ocean route; earlier Europe–India commercial contacts already existed.
- Early profits encouraged repeated expeditions. European ships entered an existing Indian Ocean system of Indian, Arab, Persian, African and Southeast Asian merchants.

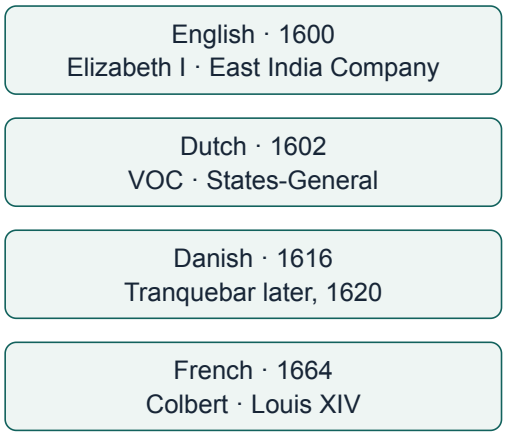
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3. Merchant capitalism and mercantilism

- **Merchant capitalism, especially sixteenth–seventeenth centuries:** accumulation through buying, transporting and selling goods; merchant capital linked dispersed producers and distant markets.
- **Joint-stock company:** pooled investor capital and risk for expensive voyages. **Royal charter:** monopoly and privileges; some companies also received powers to fortify, wage war and negotiate treaties.
- **Mercantilism, sixteenth–eighteenth centuries:** State wealth associated with bullion and a favourable trade balance; promote exports/manufactures, restrain competing imports, regulate commerce and protect shipping.
- Colonies supplied raw materials and captive markets; monopoly companies and naval power joined commercial profit to national rivalry. The supposed fixed quantity of world wealth was a mercantilist assumption, not an economic law.
- **Company formation dates:** English **1600**; Dutch VOC **1602**; Danish **1616**; French **1664**. Distinguish charter dates from first Indian settlements.



Mercantilist policy connected State power, monopoly and overseas commerce.

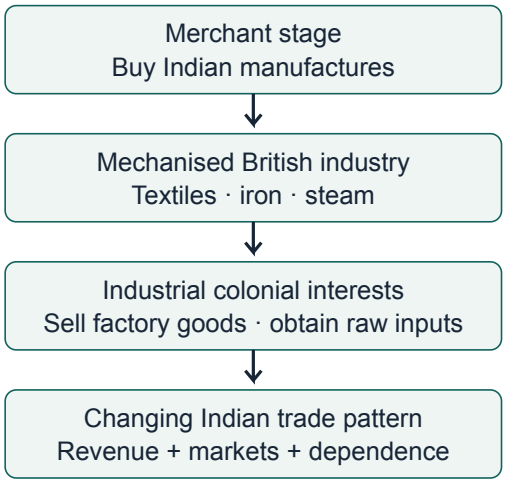


Company foundation dates; settlement dates must be learned separately.

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4. Industrial Revolution and changing colonial interests

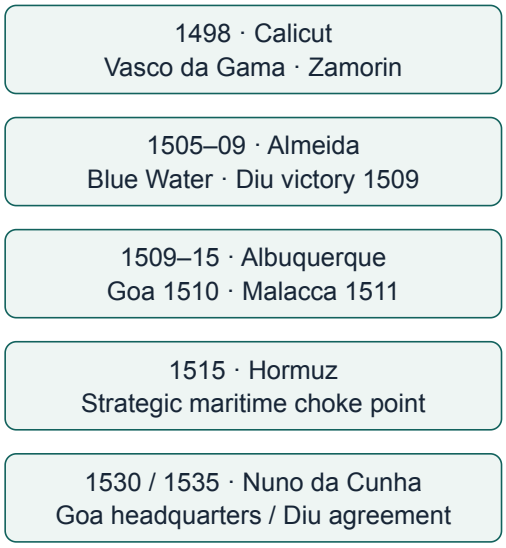
- **Britain, approximately 1760–1840:** transition towards mechanised production, factories and steam; cotton textiles, iron and transport central. Scientific enquiry—Copernicus, Galileo, Newton—and practical engineering contributed.
- Conditions: coal/iron, capital and credit, domestic/overseas demand, labour supply, agricultural/commercial change and institutions. Colonial trade/plunder supplied resources and markets, but were not the sole cause.
- **Hargreaves—spinning jenny, c.1764; Arkwright—water frame, 1769; Crompton—spinning mule, 1779; Cartwright—power loom, 1785.** Arkwright's machine was a separate innovation, not simply a mechanised jenny. IMechE timeline
- **James Watt—separate-condenser patent, 1769:** improved existing steam engines; he did not first invent steam power in the 1790s. Steamships and railways expanded in the nineteenth century. Science Museum
- **Earlier merchant interest:** purchase Indian manufactures, especially textiles, for profitable resale. **Industrial interest:** sell British factory goods, obtain raw materials, expand markets and investment opportunities.
- India shifted from a major textile exporter towards greater dependence on imported British cloth and raw-material exports. This was uneven and gradual; all Indian manufacture did not disappear at once.



Industrialisation altered the interests driving British colonial commerce.

5. Portuguese: arrival, governors and naval empire

- **1498 da Gama → 1500 Pedro Álvares Cabral → 1502 da Gama's return.** Cabral's voyage also reached Brazil; conflict at Calicut brought retaliation and closer links with Cochin.
- **Feitoria = trading post; armada = fleet.** Early centres: Calicut, **Cochin/Kochi, Cannanore/Kannur, Quilon/Kollam**. **Cochin fort, 1503; Cannanore fort, 1505**—do not equate the first factory with the first fort.
- **Estado da Índia:** Portuguese Asian government; first viceroy appointed **1505**. Armed ships, forts and strategic ports supported commerce; no complete monopoly over all Asian coastal trade.
- **Francisco de Almeida, 1505–09:** first viceroy; **Blue Water Policy** emphasised naval supremacy; associated with Anjediva and coastal fortification.
- **Chaul, 1508:** Almeida's son **Lourenço** killed. **Diu, 1509:** Almeida defeated an opposing fleet including Egyptian Mamluk and Gujarat forces. Do not merge these two battles.
- **Afonso/Alfonso de Albuquerque, 1509–15:** consolidated territorial bases; **Goa, 1510**, captured from **Bijapur Sultanate**; **Malacca, 1511; Hormuz, 1515**. Goa conquest is neither 1499 nor Almeida's Diu victory.
- Albuquerque encouraged Portuguese–Indian marriages/local participation for permanent settlements; promoted Christianity and restricted sati in his territory. Often called the **real founder of Portuguese power in the East**.
- **Nuno da Cunha, 1529–38:** shifted headquarters **Cochin → Goa, 1530**. **Bahadur Shah of Gujarat, 1535:** agreement permitted Portuguese fortification at Diu under Mughal pressure. Diu fort history
- **Cartaz:** Portuguese naval pass/licence regulating ships, routes and cargo; seizure/attack threatened non-compliant shipping. Naval coercion and fort networks distinguished their commerce.



Portuguese chronology: navigators, governors and strategic bases.

6. Portuguese decline and legacy

- Causes: limited home resources, official corruption, religious coercion and resistance, Dutch/English rivalry, and diversion towards Brazil. **Iberian Union, 1580–1640:** Portugal linked to Spanish Crown and drawn into its conflicts.
- Decline in commercial dominance did not mean immediate departure. **Goa, Daman and Diu** remained Portuguese until Indian military action **1961**.

- **Bombay:** Anglo-Portuguese marriage treaty **1661**, wedding of **Catherine of Braganza and Charles II, 1662**; Crown transferred Bombay to Company **1668**, annual rent **£10**. Treaty, wedding and Company transfer are separate dates.
- Missions: **Francis Xavier**, and Akbar's court visitors **Rodolfo Acquaviva and Antonio Monserrate**; Christianity, churches, education and language/printing contacts. Also coercion and temple destruction in some controlled territories.
- **Printing press—Goa, 1556.** Missionaries produced religious/vernacular works. **Henry Heras** belongs to twentieth-century Jesuit scholarship, not the sixteenth-century Portuguese mission.
- Columbian exchange spread American crops through Portuguese and other routes: **chillies, tobacco, maize, potatoes, sweet potatoes, cashew, pineapple, papaya, sapota and groundnut**. Native Indian black pepper was not a Portuguese introduction.

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7. Dutch: VOC, factories and priorities

- **Cornelis de Houtman, 1596:** reached **Banten, Java**, not India. **VOC, 1602:** united Dutch companies; States-General charter empowered trade, forts, war/peace and overseas administration.
- **Fluyt/fluit:** economical cargo vessel with comparatively small crew. Dutch priority was Indonesian spice commerce; Indian textiles helped finance/barter for spices.
- **Masulipatnam, 1605:** earliest Dutch factory in India; **Petapuli/Nizampatnam, 1606; Pulicat, 1610**. Coromandel grants came from rulers linked to **Vijayanagara/Chandragiri**, not Gajapati rulers.
- **Pulicat:** major headquarters, Fort Geldria and gold **pagoda** coinage; headquarters shifted to **Nagapattinam, 1690**.
- Other depots: **Surat, Broach/Bharuch, Cambay, Ahmedabad, Cochin, Chinsura, Balasore, Kasimbazar, Baranagar, Patna and Agra**. **Chinsura—Fort Gustavus**.
- **Amboyna, 1623:** Dutch execution of English merchants and others intensified rivalry; English withdrew from that spice-trade centre and increased Indian interests.
- **Cochin, 1663:** Dutch displaced Portuguese. **Bedara/Biderra, Bengal, 1759:** Company defeat of Dutch checked their Bengal ambitions; Dutch commercial establishments did not all vanish that day.
- **PYQ trap:** Pulicat is earliest **among the 2003 question's listed choices**, whereas Masulipatnam is earliest overall.

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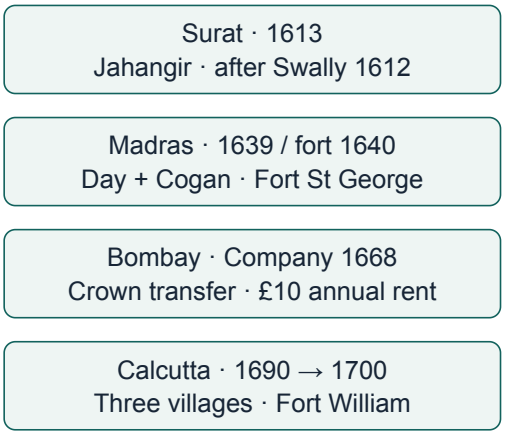
8. English company: charter and early footholds

- English merchants organised **1599**; **Elizabeth I's charter, 1600** created the East India Company, initially granting a **15-year monopoly**. Shareholders and annually elected **24 directors** governed it; popularly **"John Company"**.
- Initially sought East Indian spices; India supplied textiles for Asian exchange and European sales. **Factory = trading warehouse/offices and settlement**, not necessarily a manufacturing plant.
- **William Hawkins:** arrived Surat on **Hector, 1608**; visited **Jahangir at Agra, 1609**, used Turkish; Portuguese opposition obstructed durable trading concessions. He was not the first English traveller ever to India.
- **Masulipatnam, 1611:** first English factory in South India. **Thomas Best, Swally/Suvali, 1612:** naval victory over Portuguese near Surat; **Surat factory permitted, 1613**, under **Jahangir**.
- **Sir Thomas Roe, 1615–19:** James I's ambassador at Jahangir's court; negotiated commercial protection. Remember **Hawkins + Roe → Jahangir**, not Roe → Akbar.

- **Odisha, 1633:** factories at **Hariharpur and Balasore**, first English footholds in Eastern India; distinct from the later Bengal/Hugli factory.
- **Golconda Golden Farman, 1632:** trading privilege associated with **500 pagodas annually**.

9. English settlements: three presidency centres

- **Madras, 1639: Francis Day and Andrew Cogan**; land from **Damarla Venkatadri Nayak**, representative of the Vijayanagara ruler at Chandragiri. **Fort St George, 1640**—first English fort in India.
- Madras privileges included fortification/local administration, coinage and sharing customs income. Vijayanagara political lineage survived **Talikota, 1565**; it did not instantly disappear.
- **Fort St David, near Cuddalore:** purchased **1690**; another southern base.
- **Bombay, 1668:** Company acquisition from Crown; developed into principal western base, replacing Surat's administrative primacy.
- **Hugli, 1651:** Bengal factory with permission of **Shah Shuja**. Bengal/Bihar/Orissa factories initially supervised through southern Company administration.
- **Job Charnock, Sutanuti, 1690:** important Company settlement; not proof that Calcutta had no earlier inhabitants or one sole founder.
- **1696:** fortification; **1698:** zamindari rights over **Sutanuti, Kalikata and Gobindapur**, with permission of **Azim-us-Shan**. **Fort William and Bengal presidency developed around 1700**.
- **Three presidency centres: Madras—Fort St George; Bombay—western base; Calcutta—Fort William**. Fort William is not at Kochi.

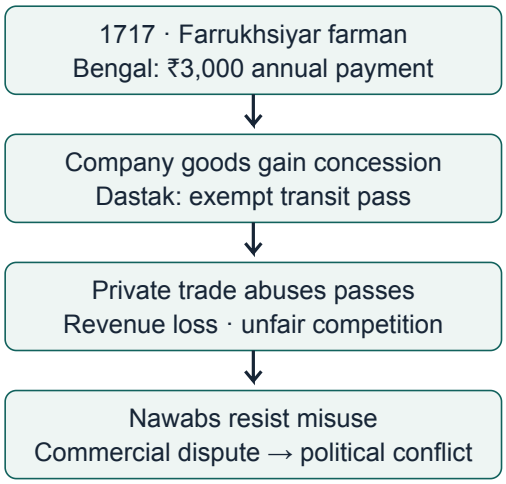


Commercial settlements developed into Company administrative centres.

10. Company powers, conflict and the 1717 farman

- Successive charters added judicial authority **1625**, armed shipping **1661**, and war/peace/military powers **1683**; private commerce acquired quasi-State functions.
- **Child's War, 1686–90**, against **Aurangzeb:** Company defeated; resumed commerce after submission and fine of approximately **₹1.5 lakh**. Earlier military confrontation was not automatic British superiority.
- **Bengal concession, 1691:** trading privileges against annual **₹3,000** payment.
- **Farrukhsiyar's farman, 1717: John Surman's embassy**, with physician **William Hamilton**; often called the **"Magna Carta of the Company"**.

- **Bengal:** Company duty exemption against **₹3,000 annually**, not ₹30,000; permission to rent additional villages. **Surat:** annual **₹10,000** arrangement; southern grants confirmed trading/rent concessions and recognised Company coinage in specified contexts. Farman details
- **Dastak = duty-free transit pass** for entitled Company goods. It did not legally exempt all private trade by Company servants; misuse deprived the Nawab's treasury of revenue and disadvantaged other merchants.
- **Private trade:** servants supplemented low salaries; private cargo remained subject to local duties where privileges did not apply. European home trade was reserved to the Company.
- **Murshid Quli Khan and Alivardi Khan** resisted abuse; commercial concessions became a source of conflict and later political intervention.



Distinguish legitimate Company concessions from servants' private-trade abuse.

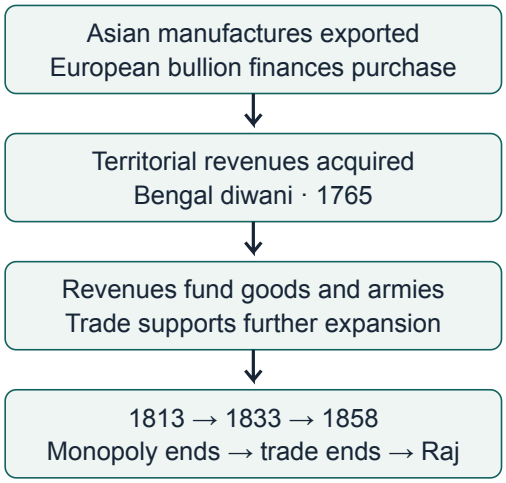
11. Danes and French

- **Danish East India Company, 1616; Tranquebar/Tharangambadi, 1620**, near Tanjore—**Fort Dansborg**. **Serampore/Frederiksnagore, 1755**, Bengal; missionaries, education and printing important.
- Danish possessions came under Crown administration **1777**; **Tranquebar and Serampore sold to British, 1845**. Denmark never became the main contender for an Indian empire.
- **French company, 1664: Colbert under Louis XIV**, not Louis IV; stronger State sponsorship than the early English company.
- **Surat factory, 1668** following the 1667 expedition; **Masulipatnam, 1669**. Tamil Nadu Open University
- **Pondicherry: Bellanger, 1673; François Martin, 1674**, developed the settlement. **Sher Khan Lodi**, Bijapur's local representative, provided the grant; not himself king of Bijapur.
- **Chandernagore/Chandannagar:** Bengal base consolidated in the late seventeenth century. Other French centres: **Mahe, Karaikal, Yanam**, with trading links at Balasore/Kasimbazar; **Mauritius and Réunion** oceanic bases.
- **Dutch seized Pondicherry, 1693; Treaty of Ryswick, 1697; return to France, 1699**. Treaty date and actual restoration differed. Portuguese and other Europeans had earlier establishments there. Puducherry history
- **Anglo-French/Carnatic rivalry, 1746–63: Dupleix's forces occupied Madras, 1746**. British captured **Pondicherry, 1761**; **Paris, 1763**, allowed restoration of French settlements, subsequently returned, but curtailed imperial ambitions.

- French enclaves survived this defeat; transfer to India **de facto 1954, de jure 1962**. Trading arrival, military defeat and final transfer are different milestones.

12. Trade, monopoly and transition to territorial power

- European demand: **pepper/spices → cotton textiles and silk**, plus **indigo and saltpetre**. Indian exports attracted gold/silver because European merchandise did not balance purchases.
- **Saltpetre = potassium nitrate, KNO_3 / shora:** gunpowder ingredient; Bihar/Patna important; heavy cargo could also serve as ballast.
- Indian merchants, bankers and producers remained active; European arrival did not immediately extinguish their networks. British restrictions on imported Indian textiles protected domestic manufacture, including eighteenth-century **Calico Acts**.
- After territorial acquisition, especially **Bengal diwani, 1765**, Indian revenues financed Company exports and military expansion, reducing reliance on imported bullion. Asian networks included the later opium–China trade.
- **Adam Smith, Wealth of Nations, 1776:** criticised monopoly; British manufacturers increasingly sought open Indian markets.
- **Charter Act, 1813:** ended Company's Indian trade monopoly **except tea and China trade**. **1833:** ended remaining commercial monopoly/trading activities. Company continued governing until **1858**. UK Parliament
- Mains chain: **European commercial expansion → chartered armed trade → Indian political alliances/revenue → military expansion → colonial economy**. Company advantage combined shipping, finance, diplomacy and Indian resources; conquest was not predetermined.



Commercial finance and territorial revenue reinforced Company power.

13. PYQ recall: dates and traps

- **1999:** incorrectly matched pair **Akbar—Sir Thomas Roe → (b)**; Roe visited Jahangir.
- **2003, Dutch: Pulicat → (b)** among listed locations; distinguish Masulipatnam, 1605.
- **2003, European entry: "Portuguese captured Goa in 1499" is incorrect → (a)**; correct date **1510**. Eastern factories in Odisha **1633**; Madras occupied by French **1746**.

- **2005, Kochi:** supplied key **(d)**; wording is ambiguous. **Cochin kingdom remained a princely State under British paramountcy; Fort Kochi passed to British control in 1795.** Do not infer that Fort Kochi was never British. Kerala Tourism
- **2006:** factory permission **1613—Surat → (d)**.
- **2007, first English fort: Fort St George → (b)**.
- **2007, latest arrival among Dutch/English/French/Portuguese: French → (c)**.
- **2009:** Surat permission under **Jahangir → (b)**.
- **2010, Pondicherry:** Portuguese first among the statements; French were not second and English did occupy it → **1 only, (a)**.
- **2022:** Dutch–Gajapati claim incorrect; **Albuquerque–Bijapur** and **Madras–Vijayanagara representative** correct → **2 and 3 only, (b)**.